

Hello, fellow readers looking throughout the internet to get a better deep dive of *Tsukihime*. I have always found myself a little confused, so I decided to make a comprehensive guide to understand the series myself. So far, I have completed *Tsukihime* (2000) -> *Kagetsu Tohya* -> *Melty Blood* (2002). Other games in the series that I am enjoying are *Type Lumina* and *Actress Again Current Code*. I will not be playing *Act Cadenza* since it's not canon—shout out to (<https://forums.fuwanovel.moe/topic/20034-melty-blood-react-act-cadenza-actress-again/>) for letting me know.

Heres the fucking truth, alright: I spent way too much time of my life on this series, so might as well make something out of it.

Opinion: Though I do not like a lot of the side characters in *Tsukihime*, the main cast is hard to hate. *Tsukihime* has a great atmosphere and setting. I would recommend finishing the story before starting this guide, as it contains heavy spoilers.

Context Before The Story (Read Roa Everything else is Skippable)

(This section is going to be used for explaining things that are not fully fleshed out in the games or just Kagetsu Tohya stories to get a deeper dive)

First, we have to explain the Counter Force, which involves Gaia (the will of the Earth itself) and Alaya, which is the “collective unconscious survival instinct of humanity.” Think of these as an immune system for threats to existence.

Scenario: A “**Beast (FGO)**” threatens the extinction of humanity/the Earth

Responses:

Gaia summons: Elementals (fairies, phantasmal species, divine spirits, and True Ancestors)

Alaya summons: Heroic Spirits and Counter Guardians

Creation of True Ancestors

Crimson Moon, also known as Type-Moon (an Ultimate One). Gaia saw humans as a threat to the Earth itself but couldn't solve its own problem due to being unable to understand its own destruction (written very vaguely, thanks Nasu). So it sought out external help from Crimson Moon to create a system that would keep humans in check. That system was the True Ancestors.

Brunestud of the Crimson Moon wants to take over the Earth, so he went around gaining followers and making enemies. Basically, he foresaw his death, so he implanted a fragment/aspect of himself into each True Ancestor (also, True Ancestors can create other True Ancestors). If there is a True Ancestor befitting of his power, he will take over them. He died at the hands of Kischur Zelretch Schweinorg (one of the founders of the Clock Tower / 2nd Magic).

Arcueid Brunestud is the closest to being a “suitable vessel,” as there is a possibility of him taking over her.

Side note:

(Any True Ancestors that are able to reproduce his Marble Phantasm, "Millennium Castle Brunestud," gain the name Brunestud—what a narcissist.)

Clarification:

Marble Phantasm -> the ability to manipulate reality using Gaia's authority

Vampires -> There are two categories of vampires (Dead Apostles and True Ancestors)

Dead Apostles: were former humans, need to drink blood

True Ancestors: created by Gaia, don't need to drink blood but have a craving

Destruction of the Nanaya + Kouma Kishima

Tohno is a family that has mixed demon blood (cool!). The previous head before Akiha is Makihisa. Wanting to get rid of a rival, Makihisa worked as a spy for the Demon Hunter Organization (DHO). He ratted out the Saeki family, which turned into Oni (Crimson Red Vermillion), marking the Tohnos as traitors.

The DHO sends demon hunter Kiri Nanaya (biological father of the protagonist). He infiltrates the Saeki mansion and encounters a chained young Kouma Kishima. Kiri instinctively attacks the young boy due to his pure eyes, which tell him that the boy is dangerous. He leaves the boy alive after crushing his eye and proceeds to wipe out the Saeki family.

Side note: (The Nanaya are great demon hunters who specialize in killing mixed bloods. They have assassination techniques and the pure eyes, which they preserve through incest. I wonder what that says about our protagonist.)

Kouma Kishima, as his name suggests, belongs to the Kishima family, which is a branch of the Tohno. They're known for possessing thicker demon blood than the Tohnos. Kouma, at a young age, was treated more like a weapon since he couldn't control his demonic blood. Kouma eventually awakens as a Crimson Red Vermillion and annihilates his whole family, becoming the head.

After witnessing the massacre of the Saeki family, Makihisa thought this guy and his whole family seemed pretty dangerous, so years later he ordered Kouma to wipe out the whole Nanaya clan—except that he spared Shiki Nanaya (the protagonist), since he felt they would meet again in the future.

After the massacre, Kouma lived as a hermit in the mountains.

Other Families

Kohaku and Hisui is from a branch family of the Fujou family which in Tsukhime is a were demon hunters a part of the (DHO).

My Confusion on Roa (Clarified)

(Tsukhime does a terrible job at working with this guy)

(Overall just a stupid character who is used to tie the story together)

Michael Roa Valdamjong was a talented priest who wanted immortality that humans or vampires couldn't achieve. He established the Base for Burial Agency within the Catholic Church which Ciel eventually

would work for later down the line. He later abandons the church to pursue his research on this immortality which was a cheap imitation of the Third Magic (Materialization of the Soul).

Roa by chance encounters Arcueid in the Millennium Castle Brunestud. He fell madly in love with her. Due to him being so in love he couldn't think rationally causing his research to spiral out of control. He failed to realize his love for Arcueid and mistakes it as hatred due to making him lose sight of his research. Roa's turning point came when he manipulated a weakened Arcueid into drinking his blood, allowing him to die and be reborn as a powerful Dead Apostle.

Possessions in Tsukhime

(1) Elesia or Ciel

Ciel became an immortal after Roa's soul left her body due to being hunted down by Arcueid. Reason being? Because she has high magic potential and basically was a perfect vessel so yeah... makes a lot of sense.

(2) SHIKI Tohno

SHIKI is the incarnation after Ciel. That's about it.

(3) Shiki Tohno (Protagonist)

After SHIKI Tohno went feral (Inversion Impulse) as a child due to his demonic blood he attacked Shiki. Due to SHIKI attack he absorbed some of Shiki's "existence" creating a link between Roa and the main protagonist. Deadass so stupid.

Confusion on Night of the Wallachia (Clarified)

(Filled with teenager edge vibes don't like the guy)

Zepia Eltnam Oberon was an alchemist for the Atlas Academy. He specialized in predicting the future through calculations. But, to his demise, he found out that all paths lead to humanity's destruction. So he wants to pursue something called the Sixth Law, which could potentially prevent the inevitable destruction by creating a world he couldn't predict. During his pursuit, he realized he needs more power, so he decided to become a vampire. He breaks the Atlas code by doing research that he started in the academy outside its domain. One of his breakthroughs during his vampire era was the TATARI, which is a Reality Marble (projection of one's inner world into reality). TATARI is a bit different, as others are like a domain, while his Reality Marble needs conditions and material like human fear, rumor, and imagination. So instead of trying to be immortal in the normal sense, he turns himself into more of a phenomenon, so he himself dies and just becomes a code in TATARI, manifesting only when the proper conditions are met.

Going into further details about TATARI:

Zepia made a pact with Altourge Brunestud (First Brunestud), which involved the power of the Crimson Moon. Through this, he is able to exist as the TATARI equation and start a 1000-year cycle of just pursuing the Sixth Law. When the cycle ends, if he succeeds, good for him; if he fails, he becomes a normal Dead Apostle.

Shiki Master

That person is Aoko Aozaki from *Witch on the Holy Night*. Since this isn't a guide on how to understand *Witch on the Holy Night* (not that we need one, since the story is pretty easy to understand and all the YouTube analyses do a good job), we don't need to do that deep of a dive. All you have to know is that

she's the Fifth Magic user. She does some stuff in *Melty Blood*, but we are just covering lore up to the first *Melty Blood*.

Story Time Interpretations and Game Download

I believe that the wiki does a good enough job of summarizing the story, even though I would critique that it should have gone into a bit more depth, so I will not cover the stories here. You can find the summaries, or well, deadass just play the game yourself—it's free on the internet. I will provide the link.

One big flaw, and a reason why I'm making this guide, is because the ideas and themes in this visual novel are very compelling, but you see that the execution is horrendous due to this being one of Nasu's early works, so you definitely will get the sense that he's an amateur reading the game.

Summaries

https://typemoon.fandom.com/wiki/Arcueid_Brunestud#Arcueid's_route

<https://typemoon.fandom.com/wiki/Ciel>

https://typemoon.fandom.com/wiki/Akiha_Tohno

<https://typemoon.fandom.com/wiki/Hisui>

<https://typemoon.fandom.com/wiki/Kohaku>

Game Downloads:

<https://www.readtsukihi.me/>

<https://www.myabandonware.com/game/melty-blood-cmg>

<https://play.meltyblood.club/>

Recommendations (For Fighting The Games)

https://mizuumi.wiki/w/Melty_Blood/MBAACC

https://mizuumi.wiki/w/Melty_Blood/MBTL

Couldn't find one for the (2002) so you're gonna have to button smash like me (^-^)

Arcueid Route (Casuals Trap)

Disclaimer: Do not buy anything from "yungstarbeam" <https://www.instagram.com/yungstarbeam/?hl=en>. He uses Arcueid parody character Neco-arc without credit and is trying to make profit plus his posts aren't even funny. I am one for anti IP laws but no credit? Lame motherfucker.

The people who don't have a lot of free time always tell me that this route is the worst. It doesn't do a lot of world building and is just your run-of-the-mill vampire love story. Fools, go back to your work life, you ape HAHAAAA. This route's true focus is on leisure, which is an argument for sport right now (Academia) <https://sk.sagepub.com/dict/mono/key-concepts-in-leisure-studies/chpt/introduction#> (Nasu truly was ahead of his time)! The second is the acceptance of oneself that cannot be controlled.

The whole route was set in motion off of one single impulsive act during the iconic scene where Shiki cut Arcueid into 17 pieces due to his Nanaya blood. This sets up the central idea of this route, which is that a single mistake can define a person's life, but ultimately what matters is how they respond to it. Arcueid could relate to Shiki on this matter, as she deeply regrets drinking Roa's blood when he manipulated her. But unlike Shiki, Arcueid spends centuries atoning for her actions and suppressing her emotions. This

parallel creates a connection between the two characters, as both are shaped by actions they regret and cannot undo.

A theme this route also explores is accepting one's flaws. Shiki and Arcueid have two "natures" that oppress each other. Shiki is a normal teenager and a descendant of the Nanaya clan (causing him to want to commit murder). Arcueid is a pure True Ancestor who is not supposed to need blood like Dead Apostles, but she gave into the vampiric impulse. Both these guys are NOT getting rid of these negative aspects anytime soon. Instead, we see growth coming from learning to acknowledge and manage these flaws instead of denying them entirely. This rejection of a "perfect self" is central to the route's message.

Now let's talk about the value of leisure. If you have read my other works, you know I am a huge fan of Tim Keider, who talks about the flex of having free time. HAHA busy people, am I right? For Arcueid, everyday human activities such as talking, eating, and going on dates (not ordinary, never been to one) are entirely new. She's a person who spent hundreds of years hunting in isolation, so it's understandable that such simple tasks become life changing. She falls for Shiki due to him showing her that life doesn't need some defined singular purpose to have value. This realization allows her to see meaning in experiences she would have deemed trivial.

To the readers, maybe you should learn a thing or two from that unemployed vampire. I am not saying achievements, major goals, or accomplishments are meaningless, but from the lesson of this story, I do believe we should not only save celebrations for those moments, as everyday moments are easy to overlook. Conversations, shared experiences, and even moments of stillness can carry just as much value as any long-term objective.

Self-forgiveness. Arcueid is unable to forgive herself for her past mistake, putting herself into a cycle of self-punishment. Shiki is very lucky, as Arcueid just so happens to be able to come back from the dead and gives him an opportunity to confront his mistake. The story emphasizes that avoiding responsibility leads to stagnation, while accepting one's mistakes is necessary for personal growth. This contrast reinforces the importance of accountability and self-acceptance.

Symbolism

- (1)The moon associated with Arcueid represents beauty, yet is distant and unattainable.
- (2)Blood shows up in scenes of desire, sin, or the consequences of losing control.
- (3)Shiki's Mystic Eyes gives him an internal conflict between his Nanaya blood and teenage life (internal struggle).

The Arcueid route is a story of acceptance. Individuals cannot erase their past or completely change, but they can choose how to persevere and live with themselves. The true ending supports this idea, as both characters accept their circumstances and move forward. Shiki learns to live without being consumed by regret, while Arcueid accepts both her feelings and her limitations.

The only flaw here is that Roa, though he's the main villain, isn't fully fleshed out in this route or does much. He's just ass. Not complaining though I hate the guy so not really a big con.

Ciel Route (Worst Route)

This route covers much of the same things as the Arcueid route. Ciel, at the beginning, said that there's no such thing as an unforgivable sin, only those who can or cannot atone. So once again, with the Shiki

murder, he can't take back his actions, but he moves forward toward redemption. Ciel's atonement is developed through exposition instead of dramatization, so there's not much thematic depth.

A good theme that was explored was guilt and self-worth. Ciel believes that she's someone who is undeserving of happiness due to Roa possessing her body, making the French town she lived in a hunting ground. So I can say it's not crazy to say that Ciel wanting to die is not only because she wants an escape, but also her inability to forgive herself. Shiki, as covered in Arcueid's route, serves as a counterpoint that one's self-worth is not determined by the past, but by what you are willing to do moving forward. So Shiki is seen as a catalyst of some sort for Ciel's change, inspiring her by forgiving himself.

Now on to further development of Shiki in this route. So in the Ciel True Ending, everything returns to normal. Shiki gets to talk to his friends, go to school, and live the rest of his life in a peaceful manner, but oh wait—Ciel's dad is running a bakery; he's supposed to be dead? A-a-and he sees Shiki Nanaya—that's physically impossible. Yup, that's due to Shiki being in a coma. Shiki could have stayed in this perfect world as his child self, represented when he was untouched by trauma. So staying here means he gets to be who he always wanted to be. Here's the catch, though: if he were to stay here, it would mean the rejection of personal growth and lived experience. Shiki's rejection shows us that he would choose a world where he is incomplete, where pain and consequences exist. Therefore, this reinforces the theme above that fulfillment cannot be achieved through escape, but by confronting reality.

Now here is my complaint about this route and why I think it's the worst, besides the fact that it was like 80% of the Arcueid route. The fucking love triangle at the end was literally there for no reason. Shiki, despite seeing Arcueid wanting to kill him and Ciel, still is IN LOVE? The good ending (shit ending) just robs Ciel, making her the sideline, and Arcueid steals him. What the fuck, man. He just happens to love Arcueid—nice!

Roa is also the main antagonist of this route, but yet again just used to drive the plot and actually doesn't do shit. HAHA, Roa, my lil puppet bitch. Roa's my little plot device with his ugly-ass character design. God, I hate Roa. Roa cannot guard me.

Hisui Route (My Favorite Especially in Interactions in Kagetsu Tohya)

Why are you putting this as the third route? Well, I accidentally started this route before Akiha, and this is my guide, so Hisui will come before Akiha. If I weren't so nice, Hisui would be first, but I'll compromise with the reader.

Hisui plays more like a psychological horror, with Shiki being mischaracterized as a simple descent into madness. It explores themes of identity, repression, and the human need for connection. This route argues that insanity isn't a sudden break from reality, but a result of unresolved internal conflict. Hisui's route tells us what it means to remain human when faced with one's capability for violence; the route concludes that survival depends not on being inherently pure, but on the willingness to share one's burdens with others. (From this introduction alone, I shed a tear. This route is so good.)

Like the two routes above it, it starts off with Shiki killing—not Arcueid this time, though—he kills a classmate, Satsuki Yumizuka. Shiki doesn't feel remorse or need some moral reaffirmation this time. He actually enjoys it, finding pleasure in killing. This realization destabilizes his sense of self, destroying his belief that he is inherently good, and unlike the other routes, he cannot accept himself. Rather than

confronting this, he represses it, continuing his daily life normally. Like anything bottled up, it starts to boil. It starts manifesting as intrusive thoughts, violent fantasies, and a growing inability to distinguish between his conscious identity and his latent impulses. This turns his “normal” life into an alienated one, as he starts isolating himself from others and his own identity. With this attempt at isolation to protect others from himself, he actually accelerates his decline into madness. That's the main thesis of this route: that self-reliance and emotional suppression are not virtues; they are ways of self-destruction.

Now here's the interesting part that is not fully developed at all: Shiki and SHIKI represent divergent responses to the same underlying impulse. SHIKI embraces his desires, allowing them to define his existence. Shiki, unlike SHIKI, resists the urge and tries to stay moral. The route suggests that humanity is not defined by being a saint, but by the ability to resist one's dark tendencies. Of course, as covered above, doing it alone is insufficient.

Hisui's role is to act as an intervention to Shiki's unfortunate condition. She's able to keep Shiki grounded, preventing him from falling into complete isolation. Hisui relates to Shiki in this route, as obviously she has been repressing her emotions shaped by trauma. Their relationship represents mutual stabilization, where they bounce off one another. Shiki remains grounded in reality, while Hisui is able to reconnect to her suppressed emotions. This supports the route's central idea.

Side Note: I oversimplified Hisui here as she's also very “messy”

I will skip the meaning of the Ribbon route, as I think it will be better to dive deeper into Kohaku's route (after Akiha's route).

Hisui's route does not offer a conventional resolution. Shiki and Hisui manage to move on from Kohaku's suicide, but the damage inflicted upon them cannot be fully healed. Another GREAT thing this route does is that it doesn't frame this as a failure. It frames it as a lesson that it's important to continue living despite the losses. Hisui's acceptance of both her past and her present self represents a departure from her earlier rejection of memory, while Shiki's willingness to rely on others signifies his escape from the cycle of repression and isolation.

Akiha Route (Saddest Route and where I disagree with Sleepy Crest)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uY5wBm0w5x0&t=443s>

This route does a better job at exploring the theme about confronting reality instead of staying in an illusion. It covers tension, constructed identities, and nostalgia blindness. To further clarify, the route argues that nostalgia is a destabilizing influence that obscures truth and perpetuates cycles of harm. A good example would be a dog starving next to its owner's grave.

The narrative frames the return of Shiki as an attempt to reconnect with his lost past. When he arrives back at the mansion, the reader will notice how it's all staged. Akiha orchestrated Shiki's return as an attempt to recreate a version of life that once existed. As we know, the past cannot be restored without distortion. The more Akiha tries to play this stage, the more fragile it becomes due to the foundation she built it on, as denial rather than truth.

(Now here's where Sleepy Crest gets it wrong; he over-simplifies Akiha's motives as "nostalgia," turning a conflicted decision maker into a well emotional drive. Akiha is a very calculating figure who juggles a lot, with a few other motives listed:

- (1) Family duty
- (2) Fear of inverse impulse
- (3) Guilt towards Shiki
- (4) Desire for control
- (5) Emotional attachment

So no, Akiha's behavior of hiding the truth from Shiki or maintaining the household isn't just a way of wanting comfort or having things stay the same. We can actually also include the reasoning of risk management.)

Raised under Makihisa, Akiha was influenced to believe that control and concealment are essential for survival. As said above, her attempts to hide things from Shiki are calculated attempts to prevent collapse. The irony in all of this is that, in the attempt to reject her father's cruelty, Akiha actually becomes just like her father—manipulating, gatekeeping, and enforcing roles on others. Akiha in this route is presented as someone who is trapped within a system that she despises and relies on.

This complicates her character *cough cough Sleepy Crest*. Akiha is not purely sympathetic or condemnable. She just finds difficulty in breaking out of an inherited structure.

This route revisits the themes of acknowledging one's flaws again. Shiki has been mentioned one too many times in this theme, so I don't think I need to talk about him here. The Tohno bloodline is an inescapable force that manifests as the inverse impulse, making individuals turn violent and lowering sanity.

From this, we know Akiha's struggle is not solely emotional or moral *cough cough*, but existential. She knows that she will eventually lose control, and attempting to maintain order with this knowledge would lead to catastrophe, suggesting that identity is not fixed but a pretty fragile balance between opposing forces. Yes, I am saying the same thing—I'm just wording it differently and more vaguely this time. To summarize for the third time, but with an Akiha twist, acknowledgment and conscious resistance are necessary to maintain one's humanity.

(Another thing Sleepy Crest got wrong is the dynamic between SHIKI and Akiha. He says, "He is the end result if she keeps going down the path of least resistance and giving in to her inherent nature." To rephrase, he merely is a symbolic future for Akiha since he already lost to his impulses. SO SIMPLIFIED. SHIKI is also a victim of the same system. His character demonstrates the consequences of unresolved internal conflict. You can't just label him as a moral failure, man.)

Side Note: I also hate SHIKI. He just shouts every time he has screen time or just cries—not saying it is not okay. I like Zenitsu, but SHIKI cries like a sore loser, maybe because he is, but so is Zenitsu.

Now yes, it's the acceptance theme once more, but this one is actually interesting, I promise. When Shiki accepted Akiha despite all her actions, he managed to break the cycle of concealment and self-loathing that plagued her all her life. Just to clarify, this acceptance isn't like, "ohhh all the fucked up shit you do, forget about it." He does not deny the harm that Akiha caused, but refuses to pin all the blame on her. This allows for the possibility of change without erasing responsibility.

There is a theme of progress that cannot be made without loss near the ending. But I will not go into this, as I believe the player should experience the pain that I have felt reading the scenes. Good luck, buddy.

So this route does a great job displaying that the past cannot be undone; any attempts to preserve it will deepen existing wounds. Growth comes from not only acknowledging one's nature and history, but accepting the pain and moving beyond. The route tells us to embrace reality in all its imperfection, even when demanded with irreversible sacrifice.

Kohaku Route (Most Tragic Character I also Disagree with Sleepy Crest + Generic Anime Channel)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mXAqQvIbgyo> - Generic Anime Channel

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bMMcYfnf0aA&t=4s> - Sleepy Crest

I will not go too much into Generic Anime Channel. In my opinion, it's a light-hearted analysis, nothing too crazy. He just softens the manipulation of Kohaku a bit too much. The issue with Sleepy Crest is that he structures his whole argument on Kohaku as a broken doll—not that he calls her that throughout the whole thing, just how he frames it. I'll add what Sleep Crest got wrong at a later date.

Kohaku is one of the most complex characters in the game, not in the sense that she is "broken," but in the sense that she is in a constant state of tension between agency and damage. It is very easy to think of her in terms of being a "doll," a shell of a person, but this is not enough. Kohaku is not just a product of suffering, but a product of suffering that is actively choosing to function in such a way. What is tragic about Kohaku is not so much what was done to her, but what she is doing in response to what was done to her.

At the very heart of Kohaku's character is her performance. Kohaku is a happy, playful person, but this is not a genuine personality, but one that she must put on in order to continue existing without ever confronting her trauma (abuse and rape by Mashima). However, this is not a personality that Kohaku develops on her own, but one that is a direct product of her relationship with Hisui. After what happened to Hisui, the two switch roles, so to speak, in that Hisui is now the quiet, reserved one, while Kohaku is now the "genki" maid. However, this is not a switch that Kohaku makes out of malice, but out of a combination of envy and compassion, in that Kohaku wants Hisui to have the happiness that Hisui used to have, but also wants to preserve that happiness for Hisui.

This creates a skewed reality where neither sister exists as an actual entity. Kohaku exists in a borrowed identity, performing an over-the-top, hyper-realistic version of Hisui, while Hisui, on the other hand, harbors guilt and buries her own emotions. What begins as a way of coping becomes a reality where Kohaku does not merely hide from pain, but replaces her original self with a persona that enables her to function.

It's here that Kohaku's character begins to deviate from a character that might be viewed as merely pitied. She's not just a victim, but an active participant in the ongoing tragedy of the Tohno family. She's a character with a very high degree of self-awareness. She withholds critical information, manipulates through her harmless persona, and enables dangerous situations to progress, even though she's aware of the consequences. She's a character who never directly confronts reality, but creates an environment where failure is inevitable.

Her need for revenge, therefore, cannot be understood without this context. It's not an empty or hollow goal, but a genuine emotional response to pain. However, as the pain fades over time, this goal becomes something else: a structure that gives direction to Kohaku. The revenge becomes a way to fill this vacuum, not because of any emotional investment, but because it gives her a direction to move on. She's no longer driven by revenge per se, but continues with it because, by the end of the narrative, she has no idea of any other way to function.

The symbolism of the ribbon points to the limitations of this system. The ribbon is neither a magical object that can heal her condition, nor is it inconsequential. The ribbon is a symbol of a moment when Kohaku is seen as an individual and not as a role. The significance of the ribbon is found in the moment of recognition. The ribbon does not restore Kohaku's identity, but it does point to the possibility of her being seen. This is a weak form of hope, letting Kohaku know that there's a possibility that someone will see her beyond this facade.

Ultimately, Kohaku's route is not simply about revenge or trauma, but about the consequences of surviving through artificiality. It explores what happens when a person adapts to suffering so completely that their adaptation becomes indistinguishable from their identity. Kohaku is not tragic because she is broken, but because she has learned to function within that brokenness to such an extent that escape no longer feels possible. Her character resists simple categorization as either victim or villain. Instead, she exists in the uncomfortable space between the two—someone shaped by cruelty, yet still capable of perpetuating it.

I can't really think of a takeaway like the other routes, really. Maybe ignoring your pain doesn't fix it? I feel very bad for Kohaku, and I'm glad that she got a happy ending.

Analysis Done (So Far)

I'm going to stop this analysis early. I would keep going, but I am now feeling lazy. Another analysis I plan on doing was Sion Eltnas. Well, thank you for reading if you have made it toward the end, and good luck on playing the game if you haven't, and if you have, I hope you have a blast playing the fighting games and hitting top ranked.